

CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP REPORT

Week 1 – Task 1

Completed Practical Rooms

- 1. Careers in Cyber
- 2. Offensive Security Intro

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1. Introduction

This report documents the hands-on cybersecurity learning completed by MANOJ through the TryHackMe platform. The practical exercises undertaken provided exposure to foundational cybersecurity concepts, an overview of career paths within the field, and introductory offensive-security techniques carried out entirely within a controlled and authorized virtual lab environment. The report presents the objectives, methodology, and evidence of completion for each of the two practical rooms undertaken as part of this training.

It should be noted that the activities described here represent structured, guided learning exercises and do not constitute real-world penetration testing experience.

2. Objectives

- Understand fundamental cybersecurity concepts.
- Explore different areas and career paths within cybersecurity.
- Understand basic offensive-security methodology.
- Learn how attackers identify weaknesses in web applications.
- Practice basic web enumeration.
- Identify hidden web resources.
- Understand the security impact of exposed administrative functionality.
- Perform security testing only within the authorized TryHackMe environment.
- Improve practical cybersecurity problem-solving skills.

3. Training Platform

TryHackMe is an online cybersecurity learning platform that provides browser-based, gamified labs covering a wide range of security topics. It offers guided, task-based "rooms" that combine short theory sections with hands-on virtual machines, allowing learners to practice cybersecurity concepts in a safe, legal, and controlled environment. This makes it a widely used resource for beginners seeking practical, supervised exposure to security fundamentals and ethical hacking techniques.

4. Practical Lab 1 – Careers in Cyber

4.1 Overview

Room	Careers in Cyber
Purpose	To understand cybersecurity career opportunities, responsibilities, and the different areas within the cybersecurity industry.

4.2 Key Learning Areas

- Understanding cybersecurity career paths.
- Understanding different cybersecurity roles.
- Identifying suitable areas of interest within the industry.
- Understanding how cybersecurity teams contribute to organizational security.

4.3 Quiz / Scenario Completion

As part of the room, a scenario-based quiz was completed in which a practical decision had to be made regarding the correct first response to a suspected email compromise. The scenario and the available response options are shown below, reflecting the room's approach of testing applied understanding rather than pure theory.

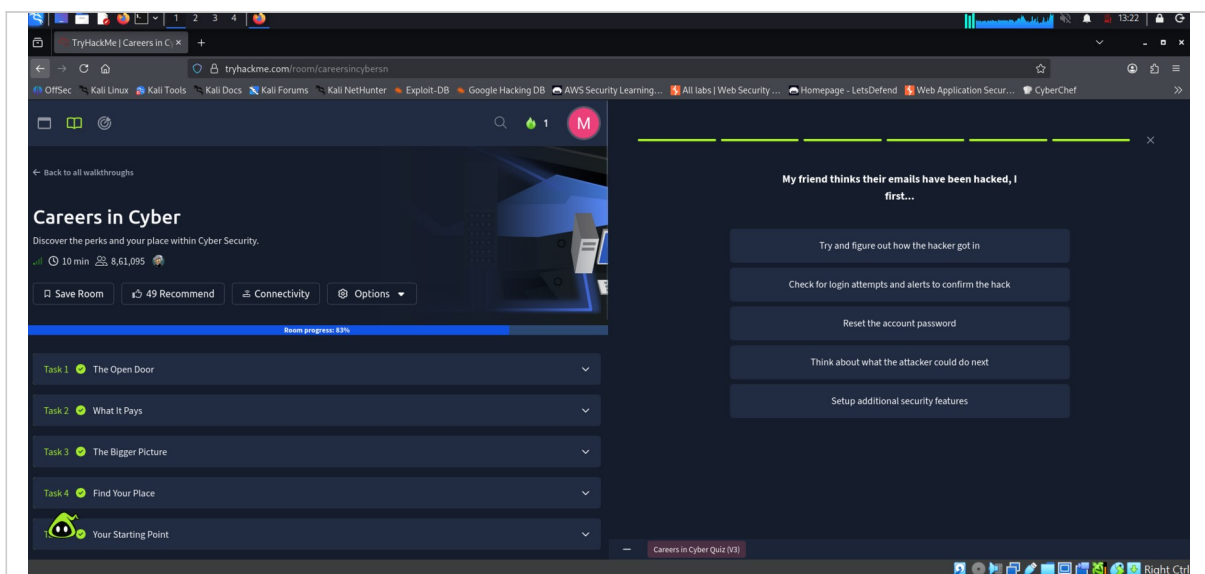


Figure 1: Careers in Cyber – Scenario-based quiz in progress (Room progress: 83%).

4.4 Evidence of Completion

The screenshot below confirms that all five tasks in the Careers in Cyber room — The Open Door, What It Pays, The Bigger Picture, Find Your Place, and Your Starting Point — were completed, with the room reaching 100% completion.

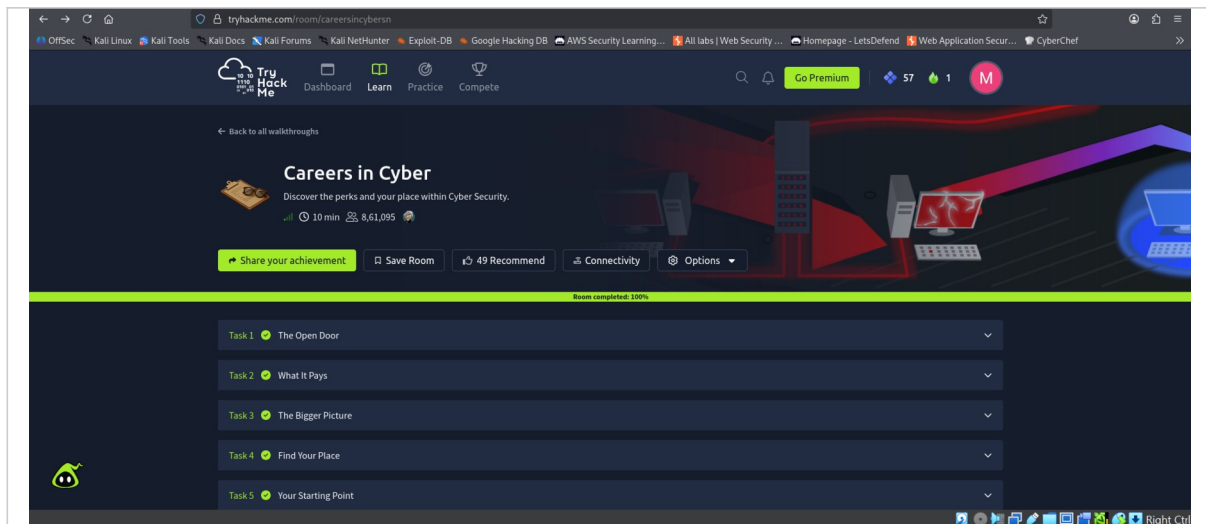


Figure 2: Careers in Cyber – Room completed at 100%.

5. Practical Lab 2 – Offensive Security Intro

Room	Offensive Security Intro
Purpose	To gain introductory hands-on experience with web application security and understand how an ethical hacker identifies and exploits weaknesses in an authorized lab environment.

5.1 Overview / 5.2 Think Like a Hacker

The room's first task, "Think like a Hacker," introduced the mindset required for ethical hacking: approaching a system the way an attacker would in order to identify weaknesses, while remaining strictly within an authorized and legal testing scope. This mindset framed the remainder of the practical exercise, which used a simulated banking application, FakeBank, as the target.

5.3 Starting the Lab

The lab launched a virtual desktop with the FakeBank application open in a browser. The account belonging to "Mrs G. Benjamin" was displayed with account number 8881 and a negative balance of -\$1,232.32, establishing the starting state of the exercise.

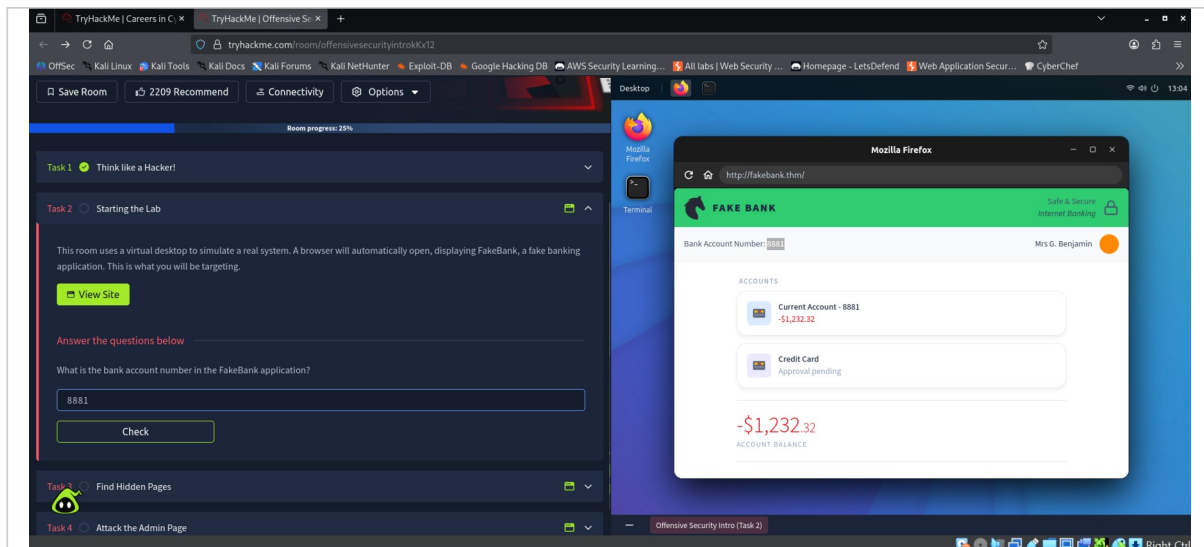


Figure 3: FakeBank simulated banking application shown at the start of the lab.

5.4 Finding Hidden Pages

Tool used: Dirb

Purpose: Web content and directory enumeration, used to identify pages or resources on a website that are not directly linked from the visible site but may still be reachable.

Command executed:

```
dirb http://fakebank.thm
```

The enumeration scan identified two accessible paths on the FakeBank web server that were not linked from the visible site navigation: `/bank-transfer` and `/images`. This demonstrated how directory enumeration can reveal hidden or unlinked application functionality that expands the attack surface.

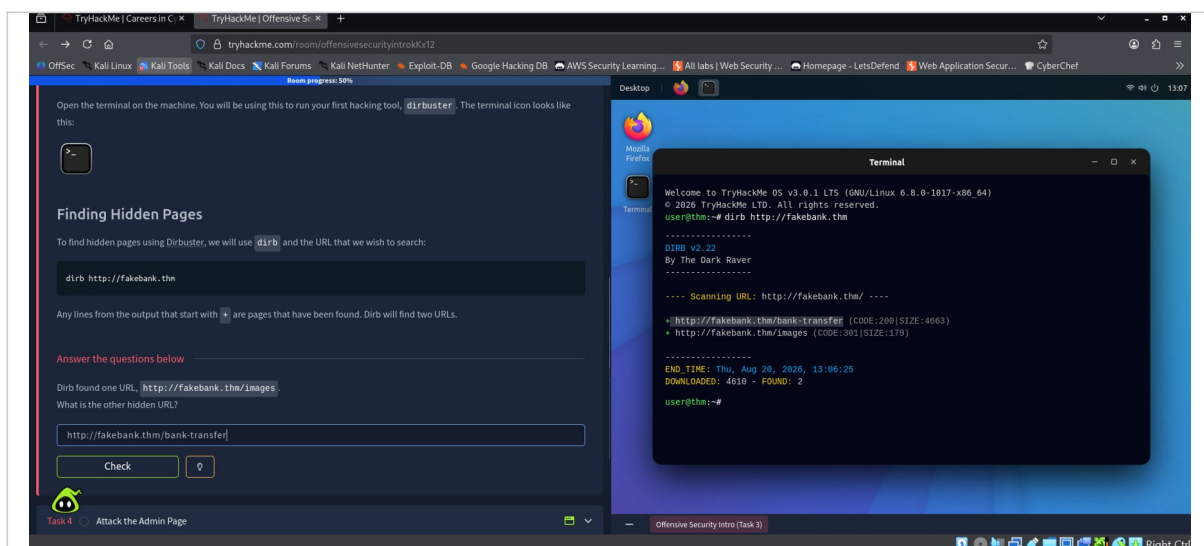


Figure 4: Directory enumeration using Dirb, identifying `/bank-transfer` and `/images`.

5.5 Attacking the Admin Page

Navigating to the discovered `/bank-transfer` path revealed a hidden staff/administrative page that allowed cash deposits to be registered against an account without proper authentication. Using the account number identified earlier (8881), a deposit was submitted, after which the account balance was confirmed to be positive. This demonstrated the security risk of exposing administrative functionality without adequate access control, allowing an unauthorized party to manipulate account data.

The exercise was performed entirely within the authorized TryHackMe lab environment against a simulated application, and completion was confirmed by the on-screen success message: **BANK-HACKED**.

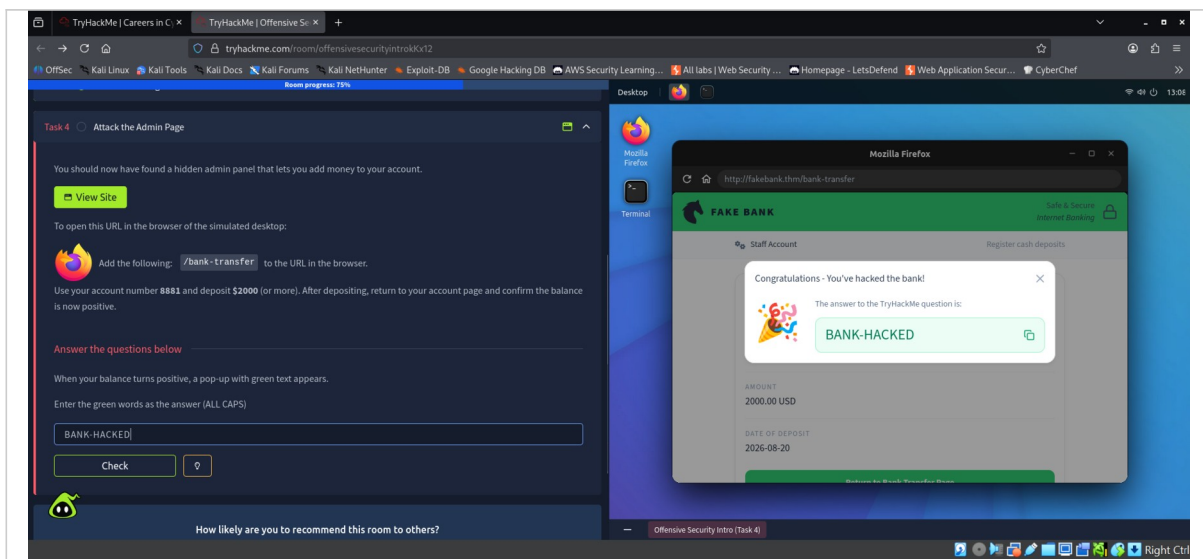


Figure 5: Successful completion of the simulated FakeBank exercise via the exposed `/bank-transfer` page.

5.6 Practical Techniques Learned

Technique	Purpose	Practical Learning
Web Enumeration	Identify accessible web resources	Understanding attack surface discovery
Directory Enumeration	Discover hidden directories and endpoints	Using Dirb in a controlled lab
Web Application Testing	Identify weaknesses in application functionality	Understanding exposed functionality
Security Assessment	Analyze the impact of weaknesses	Understanding why administrative functions must be protected
Ethical Hacking	Test security within authorized scope	Understanding responsible security testing

5.7 Evidence of Completion

The screenshot below confirms that all four tasks in the Offensive Security Intro room — Think like a Hacker!, Starting the Lab, Find Hidden Pages, and Attack the Admin Page — were completed, with the room reaching 100% completion.

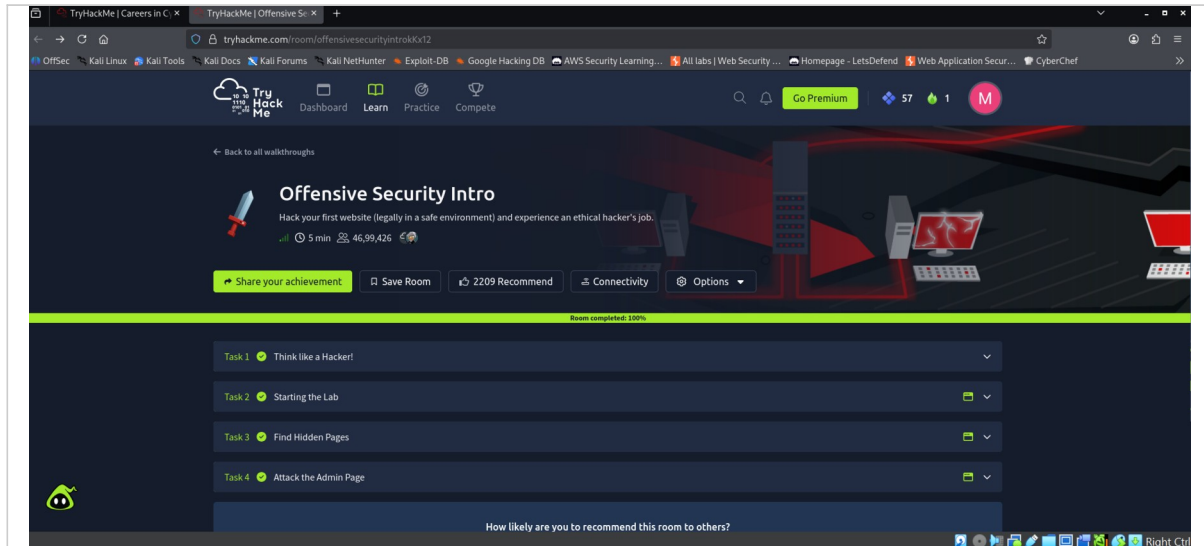


Figure 6: Offensive Security Intro – Room completed at 100%.

6. Skills and Knowledge Gained

Technical Skills

- Basic web enumeration
- Directory enumeration
- Basic web application security testing
- Understanding attack surfaces
- Basic offensive-security methodology
- Practical use of Dirb
- Security-focused problem solving

Professional / Security Skills

- Ethical hacking mindset
- Authorized security testing
- Documentation of technical findings
- Understanding of security risks
- Following controlled lab scope

7. Conclusion

The completed TryHackMe rooms — Careers in Cyber and Offensive Security Intro — provided practical exposure to core cybersecurity concepts and introductory offensive-security techniques. The

Careers in Cyber room offered a broader understanding of roles and opportunities within the cybersecurity field, while the Offensive Security Intro room provided a first hands-on encounter with web enumeration and the security risks of exposed application functionality. Together, these labs helped connect theoretical cybersecurity knowledge with hands-on practice, carried out entirely within a safe and authorized environment.